

Figure D.6 `postMessage` allows two `<iframe>` tags from different origins to communicate.

it allows different HTTP methods. And like CORS, Flash puts the servers in charge of how cross-origin requests behave by using the crossdomain.xml file.

Using Flash requires that developers learn and use ActionScript. And while Flash enjoys strong desktop support, it has limited support on mobile devices (while some Android phones support Flash, all iPhones and iPads do not).

D.3 postMessage and easyXDM

HTML5's Web Messaging API defines the `postMessage` method, which allows documents from different origins to communicate with each other, as shown in figure D.6. Using `postMessage`, a page can send an HTTP request to an `<iframe>` HTML tag embedded on the page, and the `<iframe>` tag can make an `XMLHttpRequest` to its own server.

Because the `<iframe>` code and the server are from the same origin, the `XMLHttpRequest` is a same-origin request. Figure D.7 shows the request flow when using `postMessage`.

The `postMessage` spec was implemented before the CORS spec, so for a brief time period there were browsers that supported `postMessage` but didn't support CORS. Internet Explorer 8, Internet Explorer 9, Firefox 3.0, and Opera versions less than 12

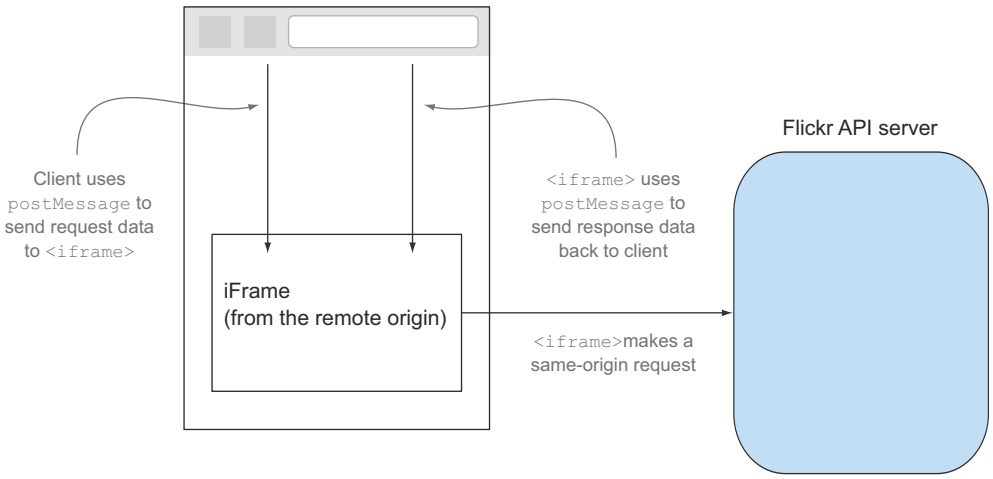


Figure D.7 Making a cross-origin request using `postMessage`